credit for the attack in Mohali and left a threat that the Shimla Police HQ could be next. But investigators soon revealed that it was a bogus claim; the Mohali attack was apparently engineered by gangster-turned-militant Harvinder Singh Sandhu, a.k.a. Rinda Sandhu.

More than the blast itself, it was the timing that added insult to injury for the state police. Punjab Police has been criticised for its overzealousness in registering police cases against the political rivals of the ruling Aam Aadmi Party, allegedly for making defamatory remarks against party chief Arvind Kejriwal. The attempt to arrest controversial BJP youth wing leader Tajinder Bagga from his Delhi residence, violating laid-down norms, had gone south after the police departments of two other states, Delhi and Haryana, got involved. They not only had to release Bagga but the courts stayed his arrest till July 5. Similarly, the attempt to book poet and ex-AAP member Kumar Vishwas and Congress leader Alka Lamba also backfired. Vishwas had called Kejriwal a "Khalistan supporter".

So Khalistan is in the news again, thanks to a sequence of mysterious incidents that lack any resemblance to the terrorist violence of the separatist movement in its heyday. In the last week of April, a so-called 'Khalistan-murdabad' march of a nebulous fringe Hindutva outfit, the 'Shiv Sena (Bal Thackeray)' turned violent in Patiala after it was attacked by Nihangs and other Sikh groups. According to news reports, the 'Shiv Sena' leader Harsh Singla was also attacked by local Hindu groups angered by his provocation of Sikh sentiments. Curfew was imposed to restore order, but there was no loss of life.

The Hindutva outfit, for its part, maintained that it was protesting an alleged call by Pannun for a 'Khalistan *sthapna diwas* (Khalistan foundation day)' on April 29. Singla was arrested and only after protests from other Hindutva organisations did the cops also book the chief of the radical Sikh outfit Damdami Taksal Jatha,

KHALISTAN RELOADED



↘ BABBAR KHALSA INTERNATIONAL
Led by: Wadhawa Babbar
Location: Lahore, *Pakistan*
Modus operandi: A network of criminals, gangsters, unemployed youth is used to courier counterfeit currency, drugs and ammunition. Gangster Rinda Sandhu now handles operations with Babbar providing backend support.



↘ International Sikh Youth Federation
Led by: Lakhbir Rode
Location: *Lahore*
Modus operandi: First one to use Punjab's gangster network. Heavily into drug trafficking and arms smuggling. Has links with gangsters in Delhi and UP as well. Also said to be supplying arms to Maoists in central India and militants in the Northeast.



↘ KHALISTAN ZINDABAD FORCE
Led by: Ranjeet Singh Neeta
Location: *Lahore*
Modus operandi: Has close links with Muslim radical groups including Hizbul Mujahideen. Apart from funding and providing arms to separatists in Punjab, he leads ISI's new platform, Lashkar-e-Khalsa, which coordinates with pro-Khalistani outfits.



↘ KHALISTAN COMMANDO FORCE
Led by: Paramjit Panjwar
Location: *Lahore*
Modus operandi: Family is now based in Frankfurt, Germany. Has his own criminal network. Largely into drug trafficking and sending arms via drones.



↘ SIKHS FOR JUSTICE
Led by: Gurpatwant Pannun
Location: New York, *USA*
Modus operandi: An attorney in the US and Canada, he helps Sikh youth get asylum in these two countries. Has dedicated newsletters and videos through which he gives bounties and tasks to keep unemployed youth interested in the Khalistani agenda.



↘ KHALISTAN TIGER FORCE
Led by: Paramjit Pamma
Location: London, *UK*
Modus operandi: A petty criminal-turned-Khalistani militant, he now propagates the separatist agenda at gurdwaras in Europe. Allegedly uses a network of criminals in Punjab for targeted killings and hit jobs.



↘ KHALISTAN TIGER FORCE
Led by: Hardeep Singh Nijjar
Location: Vancouver, *Canada*
Modus operandi: Along with Pamma and Lakhbir Rode's son Bhagat Brar mobilises 'civil society' support for Khalistan. The group uses Punjabi singers and actors, the gurdwara network, political influence and donation money to further its cause.